

mail of the week

that the dissidents in BJP in Gujarat are trying to settle scores with Chief Minister Narendra Modi ("Battle on Home Ground", September 3). It deserves to be applauded for portraying the facts objectively even as a large section of the media gives the development in Gujarat under the current regime a royal ignore. **R.C. DESAI, on e-mail**

It is quite galling to see a magazine going all out in Modi's support. Instead of pointing out his inconsistencies in delivering justice to riot victims, it is portraying him as a victim of political vendetta. **VARDAAN SINHA, on e-mail**

Strange Bedfellows

Shiv Sena's liaison with the UPA during the presidential elections, coming after its support for Sharad Pawar as the country's prime minister, is only going to make the upcoming general elections more interesting due to the party's habit of political flip-flops. ("Alliances Unlimited", September 3). **A. JACOB SAHAYAM, Thiruvananthapuram**

A Different Battlefield

It is good to see the BCCI's dictatorial attitude being challenged by the ICL. ("Cricket's Turf Wars", September 3). However, it is shocking to see the BCCI going ahead with the suspension of those players who have joined the ICL despite a stay by the Delhi High Court. **MADHU AGRAWAL, on e-mail**

The BCCI vs the ICL contest is quite similar to India vs Pakistan matches. For

one, both the sides have high stakes and second, the side that loses the match will suffer public ignominy. The only difference is that the opponents belong to the same country. **SANJEEVANI SHARMA, on e-mail**

A Suitable Suggestion

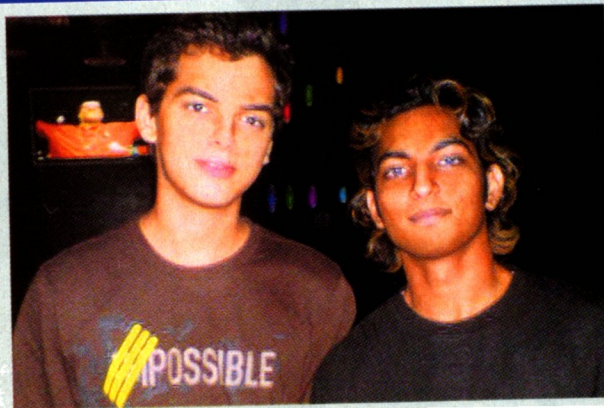
It would be better to name the section featuring caricatures of Tamil Nadu's Tom and Jerry, M. Karunanidhi and

J. Jayalalithaa, as Volte Face (Vis-à-Vis, September 3). **N. DHARMESHWARAN, Chennai**

Assault on Freedom

The attack on Bangladeshi writer Taslima Nasreen is not only an assault on the freedom of expression but also on the movement against religious bigotry. And it should be denounced by one and all ("Playing the Faith Card, August 27). **MEGHANA. A., Hyderabad**

LIVING ON THE EDGE



The ghastly murder of Adnan Patrawala by his friends is a sad example of how rich people spoil their kids by giving them excessive money and allowing them to mingle with undesirable elements ("Death in the Fast Lane", September 3). Parents should keep a close watch on the activities and circle of friends of their wards. **VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI Dehradun**

Patrawala's murder was not entirely unexpected, considering the extensive manner in which it was reported. An ongoing kidnap case is not a news to be told to everybody, least of all the media. **DHANANJAY JOG, Panaji**

Life on the fast track and the lure of easy money are responsible for Patrawala's murder. It would be better for youth to slow down and take things as they come. **CHAITANYA SOOD, Delhi**

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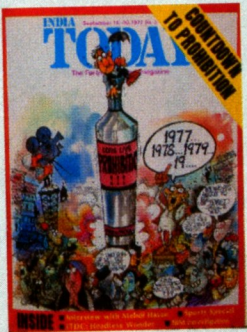
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30
Years Ago in India Today

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Going Dry with Desai?

Viewing the prohibition question objectively, it seems doubtful that Prime Minister Morarji Desai can accomplish in four years what Mahatma Gandhi failed to achieve in his lifetime. But then Desai is made of far sterner stuff than the Mahatma. He is obviously fully aware of the resistance he will have to overcome, not from the public, but also from the chief ministers who are averse to adopting a policy that will entail a massive loss of revenue for their states. The pitfalls of prohibition are, therefore, both economic and political. But Desai's all-consuming obsession with the subject seems to have induced him to turn a blind eye to at least one ominous consequence. In India, enforcement of prohibition has only succeeded in driving the production and consumption of liquor underground and substantially increased the possibilities of liquor-induced deaths.



—Dilip Bobb